

THEOLOGY THRU TIME AND SPACE
SYLLABUS & BIBLIOGRAPHY

- I. Intro. to SF and Religion.
last hour: ST:NG "Who wataches the Watchers"
- II. "The Meaning and Philosophy of Star TRek" w/ clips
- III. "Theology thru Time and Space"
 1. "The Star" A. C. Clarke;
 2. "The Emmigrant" J. Rosenberg;
 3. "When Jesus Comes Down the Chimney" Ian Watson;
 4. "Proselytes" G. Benford; "Theology of Water", H. Schench
- IV. "What does it mean to be 'sentient'?"
Hour 1: introductory material using Frankenstein by Mary Shelly;
Frank Herbert's trilogy:
Destination: Void, Jesus Incident, Lazarus Effect.
Simak, Clifford: Project Pope, and others.
We will watch: "Measure of a Man" and discuss
Hour 2: Discuss several stories:
"Pope of the Chimps" R. Silverberg;
"The Vitanuls" John Brunner
He, She and It by Marge Piercy
- V. "Pseudo Religion"
Anne McCaffrey's "Dragonriders of Pern" series
clip from movie "Soylant Green" - discuss
last hour and a half: Tibetan Buddhism, The Third Eye by
T. Lobsand Rampa; we'll watch: Bab 5: "Soul Hunter"
- VI. "Theology on other Worlds: Earth based"
Marion Zimmer Bradley's "Darkover" series
Ray Bradbury Martian Chronicles (will watch clips)
if time: Dragon's Egg by Robt. Forward
- VII. "Theology on Other Worlds: not Earth based"
"Star Wars" discussion and clips
Ethics of other worlds:
clips: "Half a Life" ST:NG; BAB 5: "Believers";
ST:Voy "Emanations"
James Blish, A Case of Conscience
- VIII. "Messianic Figures" part 1.
intro w/ clip from BAB 5:
Dune, by F. Herbert; back story, theology, etc.
- IX. "Messiah figures" cont.
Stranger in a Strange Land by R. Heinlein, (1960)
Lord of Light by Roger Zelazany (1967)

- X. "Messiahs" cont. *part of*
will watch "The Rightful heir" (ST:NG), *matrix (clips)*
discuss: The Mission by Patrick Tilly
Ray Bradbury, "The Man" from his Illustrated Man
- XI. "APOCALYPTIC - Visions of the End of Earth, universe, etc."
clips from several films.
"The Nine Billion Names of God" A. C. Clarke
Canticle for Liebowitz by Walter Miller, Jr.
"Nightfall" by Isaac Asimov
- XII. APOCALYPTIC: cont. and Conclusions of the course.
Childhood's End by A.C. Clarke with discussion of where his
thought probably came from.
Summary of course, loose ends, etc.

Tom Cruise vs. 'South Park'?

Parker and Stone: 'Million-year war for Earth has just begun'

LOS ANGELES, California (Reuters) -- Actor Tom Cruise threatened to boycott promotion of his upcoming Paramount Pictures film unless a sister cable TV network pulled a "South Park" rerun lampooning the Church of Scientology, industry sources said on Friday.

Representatives for Paramount and Cruise, a prominent Scientologist, denied he made any such threats or had anything to do with the Comedy Central network canceling plans to air a repeat of the "South Park" episode titled "Trapped in the Closet," on Wednesday.

Trey Parker and Matt Stone, creators of the crudely animated cartoon hit, issued a quirky statement, filled with references to Scientology and the science-fiction writings of church founder L. Ron Hubbard, suggesting Scientology was behind the scheduling change.

"So, Scientology, you have won THIS battle, but the million-year war for Earth has just begun," the pair wrote.

"Temporarily anozinizing our episode will NOT stop us from keeping Thetans forever trapped in your pitiful man-bodies. Curses and drat! You have obstructed us for now, but your feeble bid to save humanity will fail! Hail Xenu!!!"

Instead of the Tom Cruise episode, the network aired reruns of two "South Park" episodes featuring the character Chef, voiced by veteran soul singer Isaac Hayes, also a Scientologist, who quit the show earlier this week.

Comedy Central, which like Paramount is owned by Viacom Inc., declined comment on the rerun switch, other than to say: "In light of the events of earlier this week, we wanted to give Chef an appropriate tribute by airing two episodes he is most known for."

Two industry sources familiar with the situation told Reuters Comedy Central pulled the "Trapped in the Closet" episode from its "South Park" rerun rotation after Cruise threatened to cease promotion of his upcoming Paramount film, "Mission: Impossible III."

Cruise spokesman Paul Bloch said neither the actor nor his representatives "had anything to do" with the scheduling of "South Park" reruns and that Cruise had never said to anyone he would refuse to promote his film. Paramount spokeswoman Janet Hill denied any knowledge of such a threat.

"South Park," heading into its 10th season next week as one of Comedy Central's biggest hits, centers on the antics of four foul-mouthed fourth-graders in a small Colorado town.

Outlandish religious satire has been a mainstay of the show since its debut in 1997, poking fun at Catholics, Jews, Mormons, Buddhists and Muslims. One early episode featured a martial-arts duel between Jesus and Santa Claus over the true meaning of Christmas.

While Hayes cited the show's ridicule of religion generally as his reason for leaving the series, Stone said in a statement on Monday the soul singer was specifically upset about the "Trapped in the Closet" episode, which first aired last fall.

In it, the character named Stan scores so high on a Scientology test that church followers think he is the next L. Ron Hubbard. Cruise is depicted locking himself in Stan's closet and then refusing repeated requests by various characters to "come out of the closet," including John Travolta, who eventually joins Cruise in the closet.

City Awakens Religion

SF and fantasy writer Victoria Strauss told SCI FI Wire that her new novel, *The Awakened City*, explores religious mania and intolerance, a subject that fascinates her. "They're such constants of human history and lead to such a huge amount of misery and conflict," she said in an interview. "But I'm even more interested in what lies behind them: the often false certainties and motivations that drive individuals and institutions to religious extremism. That's really what the books are about. Religious institutions tend to be hostile to change, even in the face of revelation. But revelation is easy to misinterpret and turn to self-serving ends. Even prophets suffer doubt, and people who act in the name of God can never truly be certain whether their choices are God's will, unless they're fanatics or fools."

The Awakened City, a sequel to Strauss' 2004 book *The Burning Land*, follows Râvar and Gyalo as they vie for the role of "Next Messenger." Râvar knows he's a false messenger, and Gyalo is more concerned with rescuing his wife, the seer Axane, from Râvar, who kidnaps her as part of a plan to avenge the destruction of Refuge.

Strauss said that she found it difficult to continue writing about Gyalo, who figured prominently in *The Burning Land*. "After I've finished a book, I usually feel I've spent enough time in those characters' heads and am eager to move on to new personalities and viewpoints," she said. Fortunately for Strauss, Gyalo is the only holdover character in whose head she writes. She creates the viewpoints of Râvar and Sundit for the first time in *The Awakened City*, and Axane's viewpoint, which was very prominent in the last book, is not explored here.

Strauss' next project is a duology set in a new world, for which she is currently researching. Then she will return to short stories after 10 years of strictly novel writing. "It's a challenge, ... but these ideas have been following me around for quite a while, and they really want to be written, so I'm obeying the voices inside my head," she said. —**Lee Barnathan**

THEOLOGY THROUGH TIME AND SPACE

Science fiction and religion

Do you remember the 1968 "Star Trek" episode Bread and Circuses? This was science fiction seeing the recognition of the Messiah's coming in the 20th century instead of the 1st in a Roman Empire that never fell. Science fiction is a media through which writers and filmmakers express ideas about ethics, eschatology or end times, messiah figures and views of reality as in the above example. Many science fiction stories overtly discuss religion as, for example, Frank Herbert's Dune series. Others are more subtle as are many of Arthur C. Clarke's stories such as Childhood's End or movies such as "The Matrix".

Religion can be defined as the state of being grasped by an *Ultimate Concern*, a concern which qualifies all other concerns as preliminary and which itself contains the answer to the question of the meaning of life. This ultimate concern may be a belief in God who will reward Christians with eternal life, or it may be a state of being such as Nirvana, as the Buddhists believe. In Frank Herbert's *Dune* series, different groups had different Ultimate concerns, which came into conflict causing several Jihads, or Holy wars, to be fought at various times. Whatever constitutes the Ultimate concern of a group will determine what world view that group will adopt.

Science fiction as the art of the hypothetical has been in a unique position to speculate freely about religious concepts since both religion and science fiction deal in matters transcending the every day world. Both deal in different possible views of reality.

A chronology of religious science fiction

Before World War II most science fiction was largely innocent, or ignorant, about religion. Jules Verne's wondrous voyages were more concerned with technology as the ultimate answer to humanity's problems than with the transcendent. Likewise, H. G. Wells saw a future where the notion of the spiritual *should* have disappeared. When religion did appear in these writings it was *primitive*.

Following WW II it became clear that science did *not* have every answer. Both physics and science fiction became more open to religion. In the late 1940's and 1950's the culture was basically optimistic. We had the *bomb* and were invincible. However, science fiction of this era was basically pessimistic, seeing all kinds of horrible repercussions because we did have the *bomb*. This is the era of movies such as "Them" in which the Trinity Site explosion causes ants to become gigantic. In the 1959 book by Walter M. Miller, Jr. Canticle for Leibowitz, he looks far into Earth's future when, after many near destructions and recoveries, Christianity will be carried into space as Earth is finally destroyed.

In the 1960's, 1970's and 1980's society became much more pessimistic and cynical while science fiction became more optimistic. Books like Robert Heinlein's Stranger in a Strange Land, which became the bible for the so-called love generation and Frank Herbert's Dune series showed a much more optimistic view of the future of humanity.

In the media of TV, "Star Trek" and its offshoots with occasionally clearly religious themes also show an optimistic view of humanity's future in which we solve our problems and overcome prejudice and poverty. The series of movies that began with "Star Wars" is based on a Chinese Taoist understanding of reality. This mystical view conceives of the Tao, or way, which pervades all creation and is

made up of both good and evil. The theme of good triumphant in "Star Wars" is ultimately optimistic. Throughout these last six decades it is as if science fiction is a mirror reflecting religious and cultural needs of each era.

Religion of the future?

For many people traditional religion, the religion handed down to them from their culture, is no longer meeting their needs. By projecting their needs, hopes and dreams into the future of the universe, the sacred, or what is considered as ultimately important, is not lost. Rather the sacred is being honored in new forms which the theologians and philosophers do not yet recognize as holy. The Star Trek voyages in its many incarnations cannot go anywhere without running into some cosmically powerful being or some kind of psychic awakening. The alien races of science fiction are strongly reminiscent of the gods, angels, demons and fairies of legend, and are often gifted with supernatural abilities. Thus, the eternal return of the past, whether understood as cyclical or historical, has given way to an aspiration toward the future which projects the same ideals that inspired traditional religions and mythology.

Christianity, as an historical religion, is always tempted to revisit the past in its stories and liturgy. However, the Church, by rereading the Gospels in an optimistic and forward-looking sense, always has the opportunity to see the future as tempered with healing for all humanity coupled with the prophetic call to justice for all creation. In the sense that Jesus was both wise teacher and liberator, aspects we have overlooked too often with our sacrificial and salvation language, Jesus in ministry and teaching offers always new combinations of expressions of faith for the future which are nearly as varied as the widest expressions coming from science fiction. The Church has only to open itself and enter in.

Additional information regarding science fiction in religion can be found in the following:

Mayo Mohs, Other Worlds, Other Gods, (Doubleday: Avon books, 1974)

"Gnosis" A Journal of the Western Inner Traditions, (Summer, 1994, #32)
pp. 25-29

For more information and a positive embracing of the future see the Exodus and Exile macro-stories in:

Marcus Borg, Meeting Jesus again for the First Time, (San Francisco: Harper, 1995)



HOLY LETTERS: The Names Of God

Despite the fact that in English Jews say "God", and despite the fact that God is referred to in a very limited number of ways in the Torah, there are in fact a large number of alternate Names or synonyms for God in Hebrew, and these were put to a variety of uses in the Kabbalah. Jewish Name "magic" takes a number of cues from Assyrian, Babylonian, and Egyptian sources, and has in turn had influence on Greek and Christian esoteric studies.

Theoretical Kabbalists meditated on and studied the Names of God in their spiritual quests. Practical Kabbalists used them to affect the physical and supernatural worlds, most notably by inscribing them on protective amulets and putting them to use in combating and controlling demons (which will be described elsewhere). In both cases, Names were to be "handled" with respect, precision, and care by those who had first purified themselves. Those who were not prepared and those who made mistakes in their utterances risked injury and death.

Some believed that for this reason Names of God should never be uttered, but only meditated on. Others objected to the use of "secret" Names and Names which do not appear explicitly in the Torah—still more reasons why the practical Kabbalists and Ba'alei Shem Tov were sometimes looked on with derision.

One of the problematic issues associated with using Names as a means to an end is, who exactly is controlling whom, or what? How could God possibly be subject to a mortal's will? Joshua Trachtenberg writes that the answer is distinguishing between the power of the Names and the power of God. As an attribute of God composed of the holy letters of the Hebrew alphabet, the Names themselves hold power, so one is drawing on the power of the Name, and not on God Himself. As discussed elsewhere, however, this sort of reasoning was not accepted by every Jewish religious authority, and in many cases the practical Kabbalist's use of Names was considered nonsense or even heretical.

An alternate explanation is presented by Moshe Idel. "The vitality dwelling in the heart of the operator," he writes, "is, according to Hasidic theory...a limited aspect of the divine present in the individual. Therefore, Rabbi Tzadok writes, when someone recites the combinations of letters...he uses his vitality and thereby activates the divine realm...When a man moves his hand, the divine is automatically responding to this movement...Rava...is successful [in creating a golem, an artificial man] not because of the peculiar knowledge or powers inherent in the letters but because he activates the divine power

present in him...These magical implications are attenuated by the assumption that there is a certain personal contact between man and the divine. The contact takes place on the level of the heart...God contracts himself in the heart of the mystic..." (**Golem: Jewish Magic and Mystical Traditions on the Artificial Anthropoid**, p. 248-249.)

The Jewish mystic or Ba'al Shem Tov, therefore, could them be looked upon, by virtue of his purity and righteousness, as a channel and a vessel for the Divine.

Where Do Other Names Come From?

Some Names of God come directly from the Torah, or are abbreviations or polite alternatives used in ordinary speech, the liturgy, etc. Some of these are listed below.

However, there are many Names which have been developed over the centuries by the Jewish mystics. Some of these were very secret. Some exist whose meanings and origins have been lost to us.

Many alternate names were derived through various formulas applied to Biblical verses and already existing Names of God. These methods included:

Notarikon, in which the initial or final letters of the words of a verse or verses are used to make an acronym; for example, the Name Tzamarkhad is derived from the final letter of the first five verses of Genesis.

Temura, a form of letter substitution. A number of popular systems existed, and some were fairly simple to understand; "Atbash", for example, transposed the first letter of the Hebrew alphabet with the last, the second with the second-to-last, etc. It's the equivalent of swapping A for Z, B for Y, C for X, and so on.

Gematria, a system of determining the numerical value of a name, word, or phrase, and relating it to other words, etc. with the same value. Hebrew letter also serve as numbers, which is what makes this possible. So for example, Metatron the angel was perceived to be particularly powerful because numerically, his name is equivalent to **Sheddai** ("Almighty"), a Name of God. The rarely-encountered Name **Adirion** has the same numerical value as the 22-letter Name of God (see below).

Which Names were in use depended partially on the time, the place, and the Kabbalistic sect. For example, certain Names seems to have been utilized primarily by Middle Eastern Jews, and when the Samaritan sect broke away from Judaism in 722 BCE, they proceeded to develop their own Names. Zucato's unpublished work **Sefer Shoreshay Hashemot** contains several thousand Names of God, along with their origins. While I can't provide that, I can provide a selection of Names and their origins and uses as examples.

The Monogrammaton

The letter **heh** (H) is commonly found on Western European amulets, either alone or repeated five times to represent the Name of God.

given in the **Sefer Raziel**, which is made of the twelve permutations of the Tetragrammaton. Working this out, we get (read right to left):

HVHY	YVHH	VHYH	HYHV
VHHY	YVHH	VHYH	YHHV
HHVY	HVYH	HYVH	HHVY
Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ
Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ
Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ	Ⲛⲓⲛⲓ

Exactly what order these are to be written in is not clear to me at the moment. If I am able to pin down this information, I will add it.

The 14-Letter Name

Another little-used Name is the 14-letter Name, which is derived from the phrase "Adonai Elohainu Adonai" from the Shema. By means of temura (letter transposition), the 14-letter Name comes out to (read right to left):

VZVK ZSKVMB VZVK

וּזְכַּרְנוּ בְּזִכְרוֹנוֹ

The 14-letter Name was, for a time, written on the backs of mezuzot.

The 22-Letter Name

The 22-Letter Name of God was both widespread and popular. It appears in the Sefer Raziel and is attributed to Eleazar of Worms, though it may in fact be much older, since Eleazar drew off Gnostic sources. It is associated with the Priestly Benediction, and there are various theories explaining how it is associated with and derived from the Blessing, or transposed from it, etc.. It is (read right to left):

MTKNA
MTSP
MYSPP
MYSNVYD

אֱלֹהֵינוּ
מִסְתַּחֲסֵם
פְּנֵינֵנוּ
דִּינֵנוּ

Words meaning "their cry (or "suffering")", "miracles", "wholesome man", "sustenance", and "woolen tunic" can be derived from this Name, and are found in the prayer following the Priestly Benediction. The Name and accompanying prayer were added to the liturgy in the 17th century. Perhaps this Name's greatest significance comes from the fact that it is 22 letters, a correspondence to the 22 letters of the Hebrew alphabet, on which the world is built. No exact pronunciation for this Name is known to exist (and most Jews would say you shouldn't even try), though some have been suggested.

The 42-Letter Name

The 42-Letter Name, like the others, has no known

pronunciation, and as with the others, various people have tried to put forth suggestions. It has been speculated that this Name is derived from either the 2nd-century prayer "Ana Bokoah" or the first 42 letters of the Torah, but Schrire writes that it has been known since the first century. It is mentioned in the Talmud, though Rashi rejects it as one which "was not given to us [in the Torah]". It is (read right to left; note that Tz and Khshown here as zT and hK, right to left are one letter each):

NTSIRQ zTTYGBA
GTzTRTB SKYDGN
QZPLGY INTDKhK
TYzTVKS

אבניחין קדעשין
גוריש בשרצח
חקרשני יגלפוק
שקוצית

Parts of this Name were used for various reasons. Segment 2 could be interpreted as "Break (or Rend) Satan", and was used to protect or assist one who has been attacked by demons; it was often put on an amulet worn around the neck. Segment 5 is numerically equivalent to the angel Gzrel, and could be used to invoke him. Speaking this Name in its entirety counteracts an evil decree issued against one in Heaven.

This Name is also common on amulets.

The Holy and Awesome 72-Part Name

Known as The 72-Part Name is made out of 72 triads of letters, and is one of the most powerful Names a Kabbalist might use. It is derived from Exodus 14:19-21, each line of which has 72 letters. To create the first triad, you put together (from the Hebrew) the first letter of 14:19, the last letter of 14:20, and the first letter of 14:21. To create the second, the second letter of 14:19, second to last of 14:20, and the second of 14:21. Continue until all the letters are used up.

Legend has it that this Name was revealed to Moses at the Burning Bush, and is what he used to part the Red Sea. Some speculate that this is the Name the High Priest would utter during the High Holidays.

והו' יל' פ'ס' קלס' פהש' אלה' אכא' כהת' הו' אל' לא' התק' יל' כבה' הו' תק'
לא' כז' הו' פה' בל' יי' בלא' הו' גה' תה' תה' תה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה'
יה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה'
הו' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה' דה'
-בג' אר' חב' רח' יב' ח' יב'

This is a sort of "blanket" Name used to vanquish demons, put out fires, heal, kill, gain the favor of a king, etc. However, if it is said in a state of impurity or uncleanness the utterer will be struck dead! Probably due to its complexity and inherent danger, this Name was divided up into parts (that is, shorter series of triads), and these parts could in turn be used for specific purposes. The exact uses and how exactly the Name was to be divided up varied somewhat among Kabbalists. I have found a small number of examples, but consider the matter a bit too complex and grey to spell everything out here.

Other Names of God include: **El, Eloë, Sabbaoth, Zelioz, Ramathel, Eyel, Azboga, and Elohim.**

Adonai, previously mentioned, means "Lord" or "God" and is sometimes paired with **Sabaot**, to mean, "Lord of Hosts". This Name is extremely common, being the typical spoken substitute where YHVH appears. We also commonly find **Elohaynu**, "Our God", often in the presence of Adonai in blessings: Baruch atah Adonai Elohaynu melech ha-olam... ("Blessed are You, Lord our God, King of the universe...etc.) **Sheddai**, another Name, means "Almighty", and is potent against magic and the Evil Eye; and "**Eyeh Asher Eyeh**," said to Moses at the Burning Bush, means "I Am that I Am".

Some Names are more metaphorical or symbolical. **Shemira** and **Shemurah** mean "Protection" and "Shield". Seyag ve-Geder is "A protecting hedge and fence."

Others are actually abbreviations for expressions referring to God. One of these is **Agla**. Since it was popular in Germany, the Germans presumed it meant *Almachtiger Gott Losch Aus!*, but in reality it stands for the Hebrew **Atah Gibor Layolam Adonai**, "You Are Mighty Forever, Lord."

There are many other than those already listed which come from Biblical verses. Schrire mentions two rare Names in this category. The first is a 7-letter Name, created from the final word letters of Psalm 91:11. The second is a 45-letter Name derived from Proverbs 30:40.

And there are still more, more than I know of, more that are lost, and probably still more which have remained carefully guarded to this day.

Name Permutation in Meditation

Names were often permuted in various ways (particularly in the ecstatic Kabbalah), in order to achieve a meditative or ecstatic state, to grow closer to God, or to produce new Names to suit a specific need in practical application. In some meditation exercises, Names were written, while in others they were vocalized, often choreographed to specific breathing patterns and head movements. This was known as *tzeruf*. These activities were quite complex, often required memorization, and were certainly not for the novice.

YHVH, the Tetragrammaton, was often used in part or permuted in meditations and other Kabbalistic activities. The 12 forms of YHVH, mentioned and pictured above, which can be derived from the transposition of its letters. For review, they are (read **right to left**):

HVHY	YVHH	VHYH	HYHV
VHHY	VYHH	YHVH	YHHV
HHVY	HHVH	HYVH	HHYV

The consonants were considered the "body" of the Name. Vowels (which are written as various dots and dashed over, in, and under words in Hebrew) were the "garments", and one could continue to permute by swapping them around as well. For example (these read **left to right**...I figured it would be easier to

comprehend):

YaHaVaHa
YeHaVaHa
YiHaVaHa
YoHaVaHa

YeHeVeHe
YaHeVeHa
YoHaViHa
YaHiVeHa

YaHVaH
YoHeVaH
YHaVoHi
...and on and on and on...

To delve into exact methods of meditation is beyond the scope of this essay, though I am considering writing a section on meditation and mystical experiences in the future. For further reference, see Jacobs' **Jewish Mystical Testimonies** (especially the translation of Abraham Abulafia's documents, which relate detailed instructions), and Epstein's **Kabbalah: The Way of the Jewish Mystic**, chapter four in particular.

I

WE KNOW THAT RELIGIOUS SYSTEMS ON EARTH DEVELOPED OUT OF FEAR, IGNORANCE & AWE. ATHEISTS ARE TREATED WITH HATRED, ANGER AND A WARPED VIEW THAT SOMETHING IS TERRIBLY WRONG WITH THEM PSYCHOLOGICALLY OR EMOTIONALLY.

THE VAST MAJORITY OF EARTHLINGS ARE BIGOTED, SELF-RIGHTOUS AND INTOLERANT, ESPECIALLY WHEN DEALING WITH THOSE IN THEIR SAME NEIGHBORHOOD, CITY, STATE, COUNTRY, CHURCH OR TEMPLE, POLITICAL SYSTEM, OR RACIAL OR ETHNIC GROUPING.

WE HAVE BEEN EXPLORING HOW SOME OF THESE AREAS MIGHT CHANGE OR EVOLVE WHEN WE LEAVE EARTH FOR SPACE AND MOST PROBABLY MEET WITH OTHER INTELLIGENT (BY OUR DEFINITIONS) SPECIES.

WE HAVE LOOKED BRIEFLY AT HOW OUR PERCEPTIONS OF THE KNOWN UNIVERSE ARE COLORED OR DISTORTED BY SYMBOLISM THAT BOMBARDS US FROM THE TIME WE WAKE IN THE MORNING UNTIL WE SLEEP AT NIGHT - AND EVEN IN OUR SLEEP, THOSE SYMBOLS CONSTANTLY REARRANGE THEMSELVES IN DREAMS.

JUST IN THE PAST FEW MONTHS, OUR PERCEPTIONS OF THE UNIVERSE HAVE BEEN CHANGED DRAMATICALLY BY THE INFORMATION COMING THRU THE HUBBLE TELESCOPE. SOME THEORIES HAVE BEEN RATIFIED, BUT MORE QUESTIONS HAVE BEEN RAISED THAN HAVE BEEN ANSWERED.

RIGHT HERE IN NEW MEXICO, PLANS FOR A SPACE/LAUNCH FACILITY IS TAKING FORM. AND SCIENTISTS ARE SEEKING MICRO-LIFE FORMS IN LETCHAQUILA CAVE THAT THEY BELIEVE WOULD BE MARS-SIMILAR AND MARS-COMPATIBLE.

THERE ARE MORE RESEARCH PROGRAMS FUNDED AND BEING CARRIED OUT COVERTLY THAN YOU CAN IMAGINE.

ONE OF THOSE PROGRAMS INTRODUCES SCIENTIFIC FACT AS SCIENCE FICTION AND FANTASY. THE BOOK AND MOVIE - "ANDROMEDA STRAM" WERE FACILITATED BY THAT PROGRAM.

II

SOME - ALL - OF THE QUESTIONS RAISED HERE, HAVE BEEN RAISED A LONG TIME AGO BY COUNTLESS NUMBERS OF PEOPLE. WE TOUCHED BRIEFLY ON SPIRITS, SOULS. HERE ARE SOME "SOUL" QUESTIONS RAISED IN A STORY FROM THE JAN. 95 ISSUE OF ANALOG —

WE ARE A CARBON-BASED LIFE FORM — IT IS PRESUMPTUOUS TO THINK THAT ALL LIFE THROUGHOUT THE KNOWN AND UNKNOWN UNIVERSE IS ALSO CARBON-BASED.

WHAT BEGINS FOR US THRU IGNORANCE, FEAR AND AWE, MAY VERY EASILY BEGIN FOR AN ALIEN OR NON-EARTH SPECIES AS SCIENTIFIC FACT. OUR "NATURAL LAWS" COULD JUST AS READILY BE THE STUFF OF THEIR SCIENCE FICTION AND FANTASY.

HOW WILL WE DEAL WITH WHAT'S HOW THERE, WHEN EVEN IN A SMALL GROUP - SUCH AS THIS - THAT ^{DELIBERATELY} CHOOSES TO EXPLORE AND EXPAND ITS COLLECTIVE MIND - THE ATTITUDES OF SUPERIORITY, BIGOTRY, RIDICULE, SELF-RIGHTOUSNESS STILL REAR THERE UGLY HEADS.

WE DO NOT DEAL WITH OURSELVES AND OUR GODS VERY WELL - HOW WILL WE DEAL WITH THEIRS?

WHAT WILL WE HAVE TO CHANGE HERE AND NOW

IF WE ARE TO MAKE IT OUT THERE AND THEN?